

being used as the recording source in the Recording Control options (Start > Run > “sndvol32-record” > [Enter]). Once you’re set, do a test run to see what vol-



Here’s what you see the first time you try and save a file as an MP3

ume levels are acceptable for recording without any clipping. You will be able to tell by looking at the waveform that’s being recorded: if it goes above or below the threshold, it’s clipping! This will cause distortion during playback, so lower the input volume. If the input volume is already all the way down, and clipping is still occurring, try lowering the volume of the input itself from the Volume Control options.

If you want to record everything that is played through your sound card, go back to the Recording Control options and set the input source as Stereo Mix. Now, go back to Audacity and try recording again. If there is no clipping occurring, you’re set to start recording.

Always start recording *before* you begin playing back the track from the source—it’s a lot easier to delete blank spaces in waveforms than to start over and record from scratch because you missed the beginning of the song!

To start recording, just press the big red record button, which is the universal symbol for recording. Now, quickly start the source audio that you want to record and wait for the song to finish playing. Since the volume settings are saved for all recordings afterwards, it’s a good idea to keep an eye out for clipping to prevent distorted playback!

Once you’re done recording, you can choose to just save the file, or normalise it first. We suggest you normalise the file and then save it (see §5.5.1 for more on normalising). When you try and save the file as an MP3, you will get a dialog box from Audacity asking you to specify where the LAME encoder DLL file is saved.